

# Monarch History of Nepal

-Adhish Paudel

## Kathmandu valley

The ancient history of Kathmandu is described in its traditional myths and legends. According to Swayambhu Purana, present-day Kathmandu was once a huge and deep lake named "Nagdaha", as it was full of snakes. The lake was cut drained by Bodhisatwa Manjusri with his sword, and the water was evacuated out from there. He then established a city called Manjupattan, and made Dharmakar the ruler of the valley land. After some time, a demon named Banasur closed the outlet, and the valley again turned into a lake. Then lord Krishna came to Nepal, killed Banasur, and again drained out the water. He brought some Gopals along with him and made Bhuktaman the king of Nepal.

## Gopal Dynasty

Gopal dynasty was the group of cow shepherd who came from the South. Ne-muni who was meditating in Teku, choose Bhumi Gupt or Bhuktaman as the first king of that dynasty. Gopal dynasty ruled Nepal for 504 years and 4 months. The Gopal dynasty consists of eight kings. The kings were:

1. Bhuktaman,
2. JeetGupt,
3. Jay Gupt,
4. Dharma Gupt,
5. Harsh Gupt,
- 6 BhimGupt,
7. Mani Gupt and
8. BishnuGupt

Gopal dynasty is also called Gupt dynasty. They made Matatirtha as their as their capital. After the establishment of Gopaldynasty human civilization started in Nepal.

**After Gopal dynasty Mahispal or Avir dynasty ruled in Nepal.**

## Kirat Dynasty

Kirati were the group of people who came from east and ruled in Kathmandu from 800 BCE to 300 CE (7th to 8th century, BCE). They defeated Mahispal or Avir dynasty to start their dynasty. Yalambar was the first king of Kirat dynasty and Gasti was the last one. 29 Kirati king ruled in Kathmandu for about 1225 years. Their official language was Sino Tibetan Language. The kings were:

1. Yalambar or Yellung Hang
2. Pari Hang

3. Skandhar Hang
4. Balamba Hang
5. Hriti Hang
6. Humati Hang
7. Jitedasti Hang
8. Galinja Hang
9. Oysgja Hang
10. Suyarma Hang
11. Papa Hang
12. Bunka Hang
13. Swawnanda Hang
14. Sthunko Hang
15. Jinghri Hang
16. Nane Hang
17. Luka Hang
18. Thor Hang
19. Thoko Hang
20. Verma Hang
21. Guja Hang
22. Pushkar Hang
23. Keshu Hang
24. Suja Hang
25. Sansa Hang
26. Gunam Hang
27. Khimbu Hang
28. Paruka Hang
29. Gasti Hang

## **Famous Kings of Kirat dynasty**

### **JiteDasti**

During the time period of 7th Kirati king JiteDasti, Lord GautamBuddha visited Kathmandu with his disciples and visited religious place like Swayambhu, Guheswari, etc. and preached his religious teaching.

### **Stunko**

During the rule of the 14th Kirat King Sthunko, the Indian Emperor Ashok came to the Kathmandu Valley with his daughter, princess Charumati. During his stay in the valley, he had four stupas built in four directions and one in the centre of Patan. He arranged his daughter Charumati's marriage with a local young prince named Devpal. Prince Devpal and his consort Charumati lived at Chabahil near Pashupati area. Later Charumati had the stupas of Devpatan built after the death of her husband in his memory.

### **Jinghri**

During the rule of the 15th Kirat King Jinghri, another religious doctrine, Jainism, was being preached by Mahavir Jain in India. In this regard, Bhadrabahu, a disciple of Mahavir Jain, came to Nepal. But Jainism did not gain as much popularity as Buddhism in Nepal.

## **Paruka**

During the rule of the 28th Kirat King Paruka, the Sombanshi ruler attacked his regime many times from the west. Although he successfully repelled their attacks, he was forced to move to Shankhamul from Gokarna. He had a royal palace called "Patuka" built there for him. The 'Patuka' palace can no longer be seen. Paruka changed Shankhamul into a beautiful town.

## **Gasti**

During the regime of 28th king Gasti, Nimish the ruler of Saombanshi defeated Gasti and the Kirati were forced to move towards the east.

**After Kirat dynasty Saom dynasty started their rule in Nepal.**

## **Lichhavi Dynasty**

After the downfall of Soma dynasty, the Lichchhavi period began in the history of Nepal. Lichhavi Dynasty (400CE-1200CE) is known as the golden period of Nepal history because different overall changes of the state were observed. Lots of Buddha statues, chaityas, and stupas were carved and placed in different parts. The Lichhavis are said to have migrated into Nepal from north India in around 400 A.D. 33 kings of the Lichhavi dynasty ruled in Nepal. Jayadeva I was the first king and Aridev was the last. The kings of Lichhavi dynasty were:

1. Jayavarmā (also Jayadeva I)
2. Vasurāja (also Vasudatta Varmā)
3. Vṛṣadeva (also Vishvadeva)
4. Shankaradeva I
5. Dharmadeva
6. Mānadeva I
7. Mahādeva
8. Vasantadeva
9. Manudeva
10. Vāmanadeva (also Vardhamānadeva)
11. Rāmadeva
12. Amaradeva
13. Guṇakāmadeva
14. Gaṇadeva
15. Bhaumagupta
16. Gaṅgādeva
17. Mānadeva II
18. Shivadeva I
19. Aṃshuvarmā
20. Udayadeva

21. Dhruvadeva
22. Bhīmārjunadeva
23. Viṣṇugupta
24. Bhīmārjunadeva
25. Narendradeva
26. Shivadeva II
27. Jayadeva II
28. Shaṅkaradeva II
29. Mānadeva III
30. Balirāja
31. Baladeva
32. Mānadeva IV
33. Arideva

### **Famous Kings:**

#### **ManaDev**

Mandev was a great Lichchhavi king. He ascended the throne after his father Dharmdev's death. He was very young when he became king. His mother Rajyawati helped him much in the administration. Mandev is called the first historical king of Nepal. It is proved by the stone inscription in front of Changu Narayan temple. He made Manaka coin and constructed Managriha the new palace for him.

#### **Ansuverma:**

King Amshuverma, initiator of trade and industry in Nepal. Amshuverma was the Licchhavi King of Thakuri dynasty who ruled Nepal during the sixth century AD. This learned, bold and far-sighted king was a lover of art, architecture and literature. He was a brave king who extended the territory of his kingdom by fighting and winning many battles. During the reign of Amshuverma, Harshvardhana of India and Srong Tsang Gampo of Tibet were trying to extend their territories. Keeping Harshvardhana at arm's length he made a matrimonial alliance with Tibet. He gave his daughter Bhrikuti in marriage to the Tibetan King Srong Tsang Gampo. He also gave his sister Bhoga Devi in marriage to an Indian King Shur Sen. With all this political sagacity and far-sightedness; Amshuverma maintained the sovereignty and independence of the country.

#### **Jaya Dev II**

He was the last famous king of Lichhavi dynasty. His Pashupati inscription gives the genealogy of the of Lichchhavi dynasty. He did very well reformation in the part of social and political, different types of taxes, art and architecture, trade and commerce.

#### **Shiva Dev I**

Shivadeva was another illustrious ruler of the Lichchhavi dynasty. He ascended the throne in about 588 A.D. From the very beginning of his rule, he placed Amshuverma in charge of the entire administration of the country. Shiva Deva I was impressed by Amshuverma's heroism and administrative ability. So, he gave his daughter in marriage to Amshuverma and made him 'Mahasamanta'. Then the dual administration was held for some time.

## **NarendraDev**

NarendraDev was the son of UdayDev II. UdayDev had to take shelter under the Tibetan King Srong-Tsang-Gompo. NarendraDev, with Tibetan aid took revenge against the enemy of his father and restored his ancestral throne by defeating Bishnu Gupta. Thus, he ended the double rule and became the 7th king of the Lichchhavi dynasty. He ascended the throne in about 640 A.D. He was a wise and good ruler. He always wished to see his people happy and prosperous.

## **Shiva Dev II**

After the death of NarendraDev, his son Shivadeva II ruled from 684 to 705 A.D. He married Betsa Devi, the daughter of king Bhogaverma of Magadha. Due to this matrimonial relation, he maintained a very good relationship with the powerful Magadha kingdom of India.

## **Changes Occurred during Licchavi Period:**

1. Lots of Buddha statues, chaityas, and stupas were carved and placed in different parts.
  2. Use of coin started.
  3. Except agriculture people started engaging in business.
  4. Utensils of copper were started to make.
  5. Concept of Administration was changed.
  6. During Lichhavi dynasty there was good relation with foreign countries.
  7. Economic condition was improved.
  8. There was a great development of art and architecture.
  9. Punishments were inflicted according to the gravity of the offence.
- In this way, Nepal made all-round development under the Lichchhavis.

## **After Lichhavi dynasty Malla dynasty started ruling in Nepal.**

## **Malla Dynasty**

After Lichhavi dynasty Malla Dynasty started their kingdom in Nepal. The Malla dynasty ruled in Nepal from 1201–1779 CE. The Malla kings claimed descent from the former king of Mithila, Harisimhadeva who belonged to the Kairat dynasty. He arrived in Kathmandu after fleeing Muslim invasions in his homeland. The first ruler of Malla dynasty was Ari Deva and last one was Jayayakshya Malla. During Malla dynasty Kathmandu valley was divided into three districts

1. Khowpa: Modern Day Bhaktapur
2. Yein: Modern Day Kathmandu
3. Yala: Modern Day Patan.

There were altogether 17 kings of this dynasty ruling over the Kathmandu valley. The kings were:

1. Ari Deva (Ari Malla I) (1201 - 1216)
2. Abhaya Malla (1216 - 1255)
3. Ranasura (1216)
4. Jayadeva Malla (1255 - 1258)

5. Jayabhima Deva (1258 - 1271)
6. Jayasimha Malla (1271 - 1274)
7. Ananta Malla (1274 - 1310)
8. Jayananada Deva (1310 - 1320)
9. Jayari Malla (1320 - 1344)
10. Jayarudra Malla (1320 - 13260)
11. Jayaraja Deva (1347 - 1361)
12. Jayarjuna Malla (1361 - 1382)
13. Jayasthiti Malla (1382 - 1395)
14. Jayajyotir Malla (1395 - 1428)
15. Jayakiti Malla (1395 - 1403)
16. Jayadharma Malla (1395 - 1408)
17. Jayayakshya Malla (1428 - 1482)

**Altogether 20 kings ruled Kantipur during Malla dynasty. The kings were:**

1. Ratna Malla (1482 - 1520)
2. Surya Malla (1520 - 1530)
3. Amara Malla (1530 - 1538)
4. Narendra Malla (1538 - 1560)
5. Mahendra Malla (1560–15740)
6. Sadashiva Malla (1574–1583)
7. Shivasimha Malla (1583–1620)
8. Lakshmi Narasimha Malla (1620 - 1641)
9. Pratap Malla (1641–1674)
10. Chakravartendra Malla (1669)
11. MahipatendraMalla (1670)
12. JayanripendraMalla (1674–1680)
13. ParthivendraMalla (1680–1687)
14. BhupalendraMalla (1687–1700)
15. BhaskaraMalla (1700–1714)
16. MahendrasimhaMalla (1714–1722)
17. JagajjayaMalla (1722–1736)
18. JayaPrakashMalla (1736–1746, 1750–1768)
19. JyotiPrakashMalla (1746–1750)

**Note:** Jaya PrakashMalla became king of kantipur twice from 1736–1746 and 1750–1768.

**There were altogether 20 kings of Lalitpur district during Malla dynasty. The kings were:**

1. Purandara Simha (1580 - 1600)
2. Harihara Simha (1600 - 1609)
3. Shiva Simha (King of Kantipur) (1609 - 1620)
4. Siddhi Narasimha (1620 - 1661)
5. Srinivasa Malla (1661 - 1685)
6. Yoga Narendra Malla (1685–1705)
7. Loka Prakash Malla (1705–1706)
8. Indra Malla (Purandara Malla) (1706–1709)
9. Vira Narasimha Malla (1709)

10. Vira Mahindra Malla (1709–1715)
11. Riddhi Narasimha (1715–1717)
12. Mahindra Simha (King of Kantipur) (1717–1722)
13. Yoga Prakash Malla (1722–1729)
14. Vishnu Malla (1729–1745)
15. Rajya Prakash Malla (1745–1758)
16. Vishvajit Malla (1758–1760)
17. Jaya Prakash Malla (King of Kantipur) (1760–1761, 1763–1764)
18. Ranajit Malla (King of Bhaktapur) (1762–1763)
19. Dala Mardan Shah (1764–1765)
20. Tej Narasimha Malla (1765–1768)

**Note:** Mahindra Simha, Jaya PrakashMalla and RanajitMalla were the kings of Kantipur and Bhaktapur who ruled Latipur too. Jaya Prakash Malla the king of Kantipur ruled Latipur twice from 1760–1761 and 1763–1764.

**Altogether 10 kings ruled in Bhaktapur during Malla dynasty. The kings were:**

1. Raya Malla (1482 - 1519)
2. Prana Malla (1519 - 1547)
3. Vishva Malla (1547 - 1560)
4. Trailokya Malla (1560–1613)
5. Jagajjyoti Malla (1613–1637)
6. Naresha Malla (1637–1644)
7. Jagat Prakasha Malla (1644–1673)
8. Jitamitra Malla (1673–1696)
9. Bhupatindra Malla (1696–1722)
10. Ranajit Malla (1722–1769)

**Famous King of Malla dynasty:**

### **Ari Malla**

According to Gopal Raj Vanshawali, he was a Licchavi King as Aridev and with the love of wrestling he adopted Malla as a formal surname making him the First Malla King. He led his army against the Licchavi Kings and conquered the Kathmandu valley. He was the first king to be so called, and the practice of adopting such a name was followed regularly by rulers in Nepal until the eighteenth century.

### **JayashtitiMalla**

JayashtitiMalla 1382- 1395) was the most capable ruler of this dynasty who curbed the powers of the feudal chiefs. He is known for structuring of Newar society by implementing the caste system and fixing the status of the different castes. He took the titles Dayitanarayana and Asuranarayana.

### **Jayayakshya Malla**

Jayayakshya Malla (often named Yaksha Malla for short) was a Malla Dynasty king of Nepal from around 1428 to 1482. He enlarged the boundaries of Nepal and developed infrastructure. He divided his lands among his sons, effectively ending the possibility of a unified Nepal for some time. The major divisions were: 1. Khowpa: Modern Day Bhaktapur 2. Yein: Modern Day Kathmandu 3. Yala: Modern Day Patan 4. Kipli: Modern Day Kirtipur 5. Dhunkhya: Modern Day Dhulikhel 6. Bhota: Modern Day Banepa 7. Thee: Modern Day Thimi 8. Bhimphe 9. Bandipur 10. Dolakha 11. Panauti 12. Palpa 13. Bhojpur 14. Chitlang.

### **Ratna Malla**

Ratna Malla was the first independent king of Kantipur. He was one of the six sons of Jayayakshya Malla. On the death of his father in 1482, he and his brothers attempted to rule collegially. However, Ratna Malla decided to become an independent ruler and created the Kingdom of Kantipur, with its capital in Kathmandu, in 1484. He was the first Nepalese king to invite Kashmiri Muslim traders to Kathmandu. His elder brother, Raya Malla, was the King of Bhaktapur.

### **Pratap Malla**

Pratap Malla was the ninth king of Kantipur after the division of the Kathmandu Valley into three kingdoms. He attempted to unify Kathmandu Valley by conquering Lalitpur and Bhaktapur, but failed in the effort. He was successful in extending and securing the borders of Kantipur and was responsible for the monopoly over trade with Tibet. The resulting prosperity was responsible for the construction of majority of the buildings around Durbar Square during his reign. His reign is seen as a cultural and economic high point of the Malla dynasty.

### **Jay Prakash Malla**

When Gorkhali king Prithvi Narayan Shah attacked Nuwakot, a protectorate of Kantipur, Jaya Prakash Malla sent troops under Kashiram Thapa. The battle occurred in 1746 where Kashiram Thapa lost the war and Jaya Prakash Malla thought of deceit. Jaya Prakash Malla was angered and killed him. In the day of Indra Jatra, when there was festival going on, Prithvi Narayan Shah attacked Yen (Kantipur). Jaya Prakash Malla was helpless and he went to Lalitpur to seek asylum. Tej Narasimha Malla ruled that kingdom. After some time Prithvi Narayan Shah attacked Lalitpur and Jaya Prakash Malla along with Tej Narasimha Malla ran to Bhaktapur to seek asylum. When Prithvi Narayan Shah attacked Bhaktapur, Ranajit Malla surrendered. Later, Ranajit Malla was sent to Kashi to spend rest of his life; Jaya Prakash Malla was sent to Pashupatinath and Tej Narasimha Malla was kept in lifetime detention. Thereafter, Jaya Prakash Malla then lived in Pashupatinath and Swoyambhunath as a devotee of Bhagwan.

### **Vishnu Malla**

Vishva Malla was a Malla Dynasty King of Bhaktapur. Unlike many of the other Malla rulers, there is little evidence today that this king was particularly active in construction developments in the Durbar Square in Bhaktapur.



### **BhupatindraMalla**

Bhupatindra Malla, the son of Jitamitra Malla continued his father's ambitious work in construction and completed the 55-window palace in Bhaktapur which remains today. In one window of the palace, it was said he inserted a rare and valuable small pane of glass presented to him by a man from Nepal as an object of wonder for the people to the right and left of the Durbar he erected stone images of Hanuman and Narsinha and made 99 Choks or courtyards. In the Mula Chok he placed a golden door with images of gods.

### **Ranajit Malla**

Ranjit Malla was the last Malla king of Bhaktapur. After the death of Bhoopateendra, his son Ranajit Malla ascended the throne of Bhaktapur. As soon as he ascended the throne, he put into circulation the coins minted in his own name. He was economical and was vastly learned. He was kind and a man of peaceful temperament. He had collected many relics of ancient art. He had deep interest in musical instruments. There was no first to him in classical music. He had written two religious plays known as 'Krishna charitra' and 'Ramayana'. Besides his legally married wives, he had lots of concubines. It was he who provided the Batsala Temple with its magnificent bell in 1737.

### **Laxmi Narshim Malla**

After the death of his father, Laxmi Nara Singh became king of Kantipur. He was a very learned man and knew many languages. The hymns and other verses he had composed are found here and there. The hymn he had composed in praise of Kali was written in fifteen different languages.

### **Siddhi Nara Singh Malla**

Siddhi Nara Singh ascended the throne of Lalitpur in 1612 A. D. He was a vastly learned and pious king. He had unshakable faith upon God, looked upon the cows, the Brahmans and the Shastras with veneration. He was kind to the poor and also liberal. He was a man of spotless character. Because of all these noble qualities he is ranked as one of the most famous kings not only of Lalitpur but also of the whole of Nepal. He can be called an ascetic king. Even when he became king, he led his life like that of an ascetic. He was not at all pleasure-loving. He spent most of his time in devotion to God. He used to compose hymns. He was also a playwright. He wrote plays relating to gods, and goddesses and introduced religious dances.

### **Yoga Narendra Malla**

Yoga Narendra Malla ascended the throne of Patan after the death of his father, Shree Nivas Malla. He set up the furious image of Bheemsen in which he was shown killing Dushashan. He

put life force into it and also introduced the practice of Bheemsen Jatra. To the north of the palace, he built a 'Mani Mandap' where astrologers would assemble together and find out the right and auspicious day on which the Jatra of Matsyendra Nath was to start. This 'Mandap' is now called Sahutipati or SohrakhattePati.

**Malla dynasty was over thrown by Shah Dynasty.**

## **Shah Dynasty**

After Malla dynasty Shah Dynasty started their rule in Nepal. Prithivi Narayan Shah was the first king of the dynasty and Gyanendra Bir Bikram Shah was the last one. From 25 September 1768 A.D to 28 May 2008 A.D Shah Dynasty ruled in Nepal.

Before Prithivi Narayan Shah started the unification campaign. Shah Dynasty was started by Kulmandan Shah in Lamjung and Kaski. After Kulmandan Shah his younger son YashoBramha Shah became the king of Lamjung and Kaski. After that is elder son Narahari Shah became the king of Lamjung and Kaski. While is younger son Dravya Shah also wanted to become the king. One day in Ligligkot people were busy in choosing their new king, Dravya Shah cleverly conquered Ligligkot soon after conquering Ligligkot he attacked Gorkha and started the rule of Shah Dynasty in Gorkha. Thus, Dravya Shah was first Shah King of Gorkha.

After the accomplishment of unification campaign along with Prithivi Narayan Shah other 11 kings ruled in Nepal. The Kings with their regime period are listed below:

1. Prithivi Narayan Shah ( 25 September 1768 to 11 January 1775)
2. Pratap Singh Shah (11 January 1775 - 17 November 1777)
3. Rana Bahadur Shah (17 November 1777 - 8 March 1799)
4. Girvan Yuddha Bikram Shah(8 March 1799 - 20 November 1816)
5. Rajendra Bikram Shah (20 November 1816 – 12 May 1847)
6. Surendra Bikram Shah (12 May 1847 – 17 May 1881)
7. Prithivi Bir Bikram Shah (17 May 1881 – 11 December 1911)
8. Tribhuvan Bir Bikram Shah (11 December 1911 –13 March 1955)
9. Mahendra Bir Bikram Shah (14 March 1955 - 31 December 1972)
10. Birendra Bir Bikram Shah (31 December 1972 – 1 June 2001)

11. Gyanendra Bir Bikram Shah ( 4 June 2001 - 28 May 2008)

### **Prithvi Narayan Shah:**

Prithvi Narayan Shah was the son of king Nara Bhupal Shah and Queen Kaushalyavati Devi. He was born in 11 January 1723 A.D. He became the king in 25 September 1768. He started the unification campaign of Nepal.

### **Start of Unification Campaign:**

Gorkha was a small hilly kingdom with little wealth. After Prithvi Narayan Shah became king on 25 September 1768, he started unification of Nepal. He began his campaign from Nuwakot. Present Nepal, earlier divided into small kingdom like Baise, Chaubise, Malla, Sen, etc which had made the country vulnerable to the foreign attack especially from British ruler, who were already capturing India. Before the Shah dynasty united Nepal, only Kathmandu was known as Nepal or Nepal Mandala. After conquering all the small kingdoms of Nepal in the mid-eighteenth century, King Prithvi Narayan Shah moved his capital to Kathmandu from Gorkha and named the newly created empire, Nepal.

### **First victory of Prithvi Narayan Shah in Nuwakot:**

Nara Bhupal Shah, Prithvi Narayan Shah's father, had already tried to invade Nuwakot in during his reign, and failed. At that time, Nuwakot was under the administrative control of Kantipur (today known as Kathmandu). Kantipur supported Nuwakot. Following his defeat, Nara Bhupal Shah gave up his efforts and handed the administrative power over to Prithvi Narayan Shah and Chandra prabhawati (the eldest queen of Nara Bhupal Shah).

Nuwakot was the trade route between Tibet and Kathmandu, and the western gateway to Kathmandu valley. Prithvi Narayan Shah sent Gorkhali troops, under Kaji Biraj Thapa, to attack Nuwakot. Biraj Thapa waited at Khinchet by the side of Trishuli River for an appropriate time to launch the attack. Prithvi Narayan Shah didn't like the strategy of Biraj Thapa and began to mistrust him following the report by Maheshwor Panta. So, he sent another Gorkhali battle group under Maheshwor Panta. The troops under Maheshwor Panta were defeated.

Later under the command of Kaji Kalu Pandey Gorkhali troops attacked Nuwakot from three sides and conquered Nuwakot.

## **Attack in Kritipur**

Despite his initial resentment of Kaji KaluPande that the valley kings were well prepared and the Gorkhalis were not, Pande agreed for battle against the Kingdom of Kirtipur in the Kathmandu valley on being insisted from the monarch Prithvi Narayan Shah. The Gorkhalis had set up a base on Naikap to mount their assaults on Kirtipur. They were armed with swords, bows and arrows and muskets. The two forces fought on the plain of Tyangla Phant in the northwest of Kirtipur. Surapratap Shah, the King's brother lost his right eye to an arrow while scaling the city wall. Dr. Angelo treated Surya Pratap when he lost his eye. The Gorkhali commander Kaji KaluPande was surrounded and killed, and the Gorkhali king himself narrowly escaped with his life into the surrounding hills. The King of Gorkha Prithvi Narayan sent his army to attack Kirtipur a third time under the command of Surpratap. In response, the three kings of valley joined forces and sent their troops to the relief of Kirtipur, but they could not dislodge the Gorkhalis from their positions. A noble of Lalitpur named Danuvanta crossed over to Shah's side and let the Gorkhalis into the town.

The victory in the Battle of Kirtipur climaxed Shah's two-decade-long effort to take possession of the wealthy Kathmandu Valley. After the fall of Kirtipur, Shah took the other cities Kathmandu and Lalitpur in 1768 and Bhaktapur in 1769, completing his conquest of the valley. Prithivi Narayan Shah, till his regime period extended the border of Nepal till Tista River in the east.

Prithivi Narayan Shah died in January 11, 1775. After the death of Prithivi Narayan Shah his son Pratap Shah ascended the throne of Nepal in 11 January 1775 A.D.

## **Role of Pratap Shah in Unification campaign**

Pratap Singh Shah ruled only up to 1777 for 36 months, and died of smallpox at the age of 26. He was succeeded by his two-year-old son RanaBahadur Shah. He did not actively participate in the unification campaign led by his father.

## **Role of Rajendra Laxmi in Unification Campaign**

Rajendra Laxmi was the wife of Paratap Singh and mother of Rana Bahadur Shah. After the death of her husband, her son Rana Bahadur Shah became the king of Nepal at the age of two and half years. Rajendra Laxmi became the regent of her son. She became regent on 17 November 1777 and she was taken prisoner in silver handcuffs in 1778. She was restored on 20 June 1779 and continued to be queen regent until her death. During the time, the principalities of Lambjang, Kaski and Tanahun were annexed in the kingdom of Nepal, under her military leadership. Queen Regent Rajendra RajyaLaxmi repelled the combined attacks of the Chaubise kings, and expanded Nepal's borders up to Kali Gandaki. She is viewed as an able administrator who extended King Prithvi Narayan Shah's military campaign. However, her reign was not free

of problems, due to her strife with her brother-in-law Bahadur Shah; her court had become a space for courtly intrigues and conspiracies. Rajendra Laxmi died on 1785 due to tuberculosis in Hanumandhoka Palace of Kathmandu.

## **Role of Bahadur Shah in Unification Campaign**

Bahadur Shah was the youngest son of Prithvi Narayan Shah, his eldest son Pratap Singh Shah became the king of Nepal, but he died soon. His two and half year's old son, Rana Bahadur Shah, ascended the throne of Nepal. As he was an infant, his mother Rajendra Laxmi Shah ruled as a regent. Relationship between Bahadur Shah and Rajendra Laxmi was not so good. So, Bahadur Shah went to live in India. He returned to Nepal after the death of Rajendra Laxmi and started to rule as the regent of his nephew Rana Bahadur Shah. Prithvi Narayan Shah wanted to unify the whole country. Bahadur Shah helped fulfil this dream of Prithvi Narayan Shah. He unified the Baise states including Kumaun, Garhwal and Almora in the west and up to Sikkim in the east. He proved himself to be a worthy son of a worthy father. Bahadur Shah was a true patriot and a great diplomat. He married the daughter of Mahadutta Sen, the king of Palpa. He did so as Palpa was a powerful state which could have been an obstacle in his unification campaign. When Rana Bahadur Shah came of age, he did not like his Uncle Bahadur Shah. He accused Bahadur Shah of misusing the state treasurer and imprisoned him. Bahadur Shah died in prison in 1795 AD.

## **Rana Bahadur Shah**

Rana Bahadur Shah was the elder son of Pratap Shah and Rajendra Rajya Laxmi Shah. After the premature death of Pratap Shah, Rana Bahadur Shah ascended the throne of Shah Dynasty. At the age of two and half years Rana Bahadur Shah was declared as the new king of Nepal. As he was infant his mother Rajendra Rajya Laxmi Shah ruled as a regent.

### **Role of Rana Bahadur Shah in Unification Campaign**

Rana Bahadur Shah was the elder son of Pratap Singh Shah and Queen Rajendra Rajya Laxmi Shah. After the premature death of Pratap Singh Shah, Rana Bahadur Shah ascended the throne of Nepal at the age of two and a half years. As he was an infant, his mother ruled as a regent.

After coming to power, Rana Bahadur Shah ruled Nepal autocratically. His rule was marked by internal conflicts, mismanagement, and instability. He was deeply influenced by his personal interests and emotions rather than state affairs. His obsession with Queen Kantavati weakened his administration. After her death, he became mentally disturbed and abdicated the throne in favor of his infant son Girvan Yuddha Bikram Shah in 1799 A.D.

Later, Rana Bahadur Shah went to Varanasi, India. After returning to Nepal, he tried to regain power, which created chaos in the royal court. In 1806 A.D., Rana Bahadur Shah was assassinated by his stepbrother Sher Bahadur Shah at Hanumandhoka Palace. This incident led to the **Bhandarkhal Massacre**, where Bhimsen Thapa emerged as the most powerful figure in Nepal.

## **Girvan Yuddha Bikram Shah (1799–1816)**

Girvan Yuddha Bikram Shah became king at a very young age. Due to his minority, the real power was exercised by Mukhtiyar Bhimsen Thapa. During his reign, Nepal fought the **Anglo-Nepal War (1814–1816)** against the British East India Company.

Nepal was defeated in the war and was forced to sign the **Sugauli Treaty (1816)**. According to this treaty, Nepal lost large territories such as Kumaun, Garhwal, and parts of Terai. The treaty significantly reduced Nepal's territorial size and sovereignty. Girvan Yuddha Bikram Shah died in 1816 A.D.

### **Rajendra Bikram Shah (1816–1847)**

Rajendra Bikram Shah ascended the throne at the age of three. Bhimsen Thapa continued to rule as Mukhtiyar. However, palace conspiracies weakened Bhimsen Thapa's power, and he was imprisoned and later committed suicide.

Rajendra Bikram Shah was weak and indecisive. His reign was marked by power struggles among nobles. Eventually, **Jung Bahadur Rana** rose to power after the **Kot Massacre of 1846**, which ended Shah kings' direct rule and began the **Rana Regime**. Rajendra Bikram Shah was imprisoned and later exiled.

### **Surendra Bikram Shah (1847–1881)**

Surendra Bikram Shah became king after his father Rajendra Bikram Shah. However, real power remained with Jung Bahadur Rana and his successors. Surendra Bikram Shah was a ceremonial king with no administrative authority.

During his reign, the Rana system became stronger and more centralized. Nepal remained isolated from the outside world, and Shah kings were reduced to symbolic figures.

### **Prithivi Bir Bikram Shah (1881–1911)**

Prithivi Bir Bikram Shah ascended the throne at a young age. The Rana Prime Ministers continued to rule Nepal absolutely. The king had no real power.

During this period, Nepal maintained diplomatic relations with British India. The Rana rulers focused on maintaining their authority rather than national development.

### **Tribhuvan Bir Bikram Shah (1911–1955)**

Tribhuvan Bir Bikram Shah is regarded as a turning point king in Nepalese history. Although the Ranas held power, King Tribhuvan supported democratic movements against the Rana regime.

In 1950 A.D., King Tribhuvan took refuge in the Indian Embassy, which weakened the Rana rulers. With Indian support and popular movements, the **Rana Regime ended in 1951 A.D.**, and democracy was

introduced in Nepal. King Tribhuvan returned as the constitutional monarch. He died in 1955 A.D. He is declared as the Nations's Father too.

### **Mahendra Bir Bikram Shah (1955–1972)**

King Mahendra ascended the throne after King Tribhuvan. Initially, Nepal followed a democratic system. However, in **1960 A.D.**, King Mahendra dissolved the elected parliament, imprisoned political leaders, and introduced the **Panchayat System**.

The Panchayat system centralized power in the monarchy. Although development projects were initiated, political freedom was restricted. King Mahendra ruled as an absolute monarch until his death in 1972 A.D.

### **Birendra Bir Bikram Shah (1972–2001)**

King Birendra ascended the throne after King Mahendra. He continued the Panchayat system initially. In **1990 A.D.**, a mass movement known as **Jana Andolan I** forced the king to restore multiparty democracy and constitutional monarchy.

Nepal entered a new democratic era. However, political instability and the **Maoist Insurgency (1996)** weakened the state.

### **Royal Palace (Durbar) Massacre – 1 June 2001**

On 1 June 2001, a tragic incident occurred at the Narayanhiti Royal Palace. Crown Prince **Dipendra** shot and killed King Birendra, Queen Aishwarya, and several other royal family members before shooting himself.

King Birendra died on the same night, while Dipendra was declared king in a coma and died three days later. This incident shocked the entire nation and is known as the **Royal Palace (Durbar) Massacre**.

### **Gyanendra Bir Bikram Shah (2001–2008)**

After the death of King Birendra and Dipendra, **Gyanendra Bir Bikram Shah**, brother of King Birendra, ascended the throne.

King Gyanendra tried to regain absolute power. In **2005 A.D.**, he dissolved parliament and assumed direct rule, which led to massive protests.

In **2006 A.D.**, **Jana Andolan II** forced the king to restore parliament. The monarchy lost all executive powers. Finally, on **28 May 2008 A.D.**, Nepal was declared a **Federal Democratic Republic**, and the **Shah Dynasty officially ended**.

The Shah Dynasty ruled Nepal from 25 September 1768 A.D. to 28 May 2008 A.D. for nearly 240 years. It played a crucial role in the unification of Nepal but ended due to political instability, popular movements, and demand for democracy. And with that the long run monarchy in Nepal came to an end. And Nepal became **Federal Democratic Republic of Nepal**.